



$\times 46,492 = \text{₹}1,48,774$ is the average annual salary of FarmVille players.

The average daily income thus works out to $1,48,774 / 365 = \text{₹}407.6$.

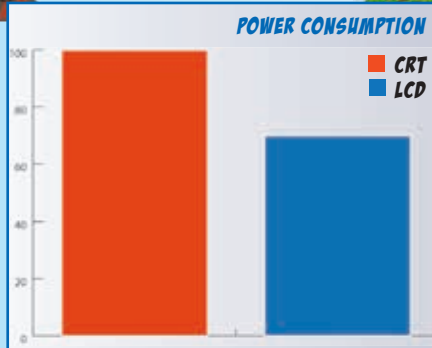
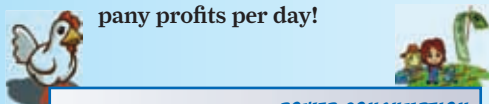
Since every FarmVille player, on average, spends 14.17 per cent of their working day on it, this translates to $(14.16/100) \times 407.6 = \text{₹}57.743$ is being wasted per person on FarmVille every day!



For the whole of India that works out to $1,44,000 \times 57.72 = \text{₹}83,15,040$ in wasted wages per day. Again, a very conservative figure.

Bottomlines

Based on another study, corporate Indian companies pay their employees an average salary of ₹4.8 lakh per annum^[4], and make a profit of ₹6 lakh per annum per employee. This means the profit-to-salary ratio per employee works out to $6 / 4.8 = 1.25$ – for every ₹100 a company pays you, they expect a profit of ₹125. Applying that ratio to the amount of wasted wages per day we get a figure of $1.25 \times 83,11,680 = \text{₹}103,93,800$ is being lost in terms of Indian company profits per day!



Power struggles



Moving on, an average PC running a CRT monitor will consume 100W per hour, which will

consume 0.1 units.

Based on our thinkdigit.com analytics data, 35 per cent of visitors are still using CRT resolutions – however, to be conservative again, we've assumed that only 30 per cent of people playing FarmVille are on CRTs and the rest on LCDs. The average PC with an LCD monitor uses about 70W per hour, or 0.07 units.



Thus, we're assuming that of all the 3,60,000 people playing FarmVille (remember this includes home and office users, since we're only calculating power usage here), $3,60,000 \times 30\% = 1,08,000$ are on CRTs while 2,52,000 are on LCDs.



Now the average cost per unit of electricity across India is ₹5.5^[5]. Thus 68 minutes of FarmVille per day would work out to $(5.5 \times 1,08,000 \times 0.1 \times 68 / 60) + (5.5 \times 2,52,000 \times 0.07 \times 68 / 60) = \text{₹}68,320 + \text{₹}1,09,956 = \text{₹}1,78,276$ per day in electric bills.



This is conservative, because we're taking a very low power PC and not even counting the power that speakers draw when you play it with sound.

Totalling up

To see details of the totalling up, look at the box on your right. What this amounts to is that India (which includes you, the FarmVille player and hapless Indian companies) spends / loses about ₹689,37,97,340 per year!

Now imagine what that total would be if you were to start totalling up all the losses due to *all* the games we play – even just those in office hours?

Something tells us we're wasting billions of dollars on things such as Facebook, *Angry Birds*, and even good old *Solitaire*... and we didn't even know it! 



How much India pays to play FarmVille everyday:

₹83,15,040
(employee wages)
+

₹103,93,800
(company losses)
+

₹1,78,276
(electric bills)
=

₹1,88,87,116

How much India pays to play FarmVille every year:

₹1,88,87,116
X

365
=

₹689,37,97,340



Yeah, almost 700 crore rupees! This doesn't even take into account the real money being spent on micro transactions within FarmVille. The next time you consider logging into FarmVille, ask yourself – is this really important? Like ₹700 crore important?

Link Farming

^[1] Interview with Shan Kadavil, Country Manager Zynga – bit.ly/pHXTLc

^[2] Internet usage statistics of India – bit.ly/qV0y9m

^[3] Manny Anekal speaks at SXSW 2011 – on.mash.to/p7VnyY

^[4] Juxt India Online Report Syndicated Research Page – bit.ly/qjXU3e

^[5] Indian Energy Exchange – bit.ly/qN02Ig

